

Jamiatul Ulama Johannesburg

الأضحية: الدليل الكامل للأحكام

Qurbāni: Complete Ruling Guide

PDF · 12 pages · Dhul-Ḥijjah



وما علينا إلا البلاغ المبين

"Clear propagation is our only responsibility." — Sūrah Yāsīn 36:17

The Obligation of Qurbāni

وجوب الأضحية

فصل لربك وانحر

Allah says: "So pray to your Lord and sacrifice [to Him alone]." (Sūrah al-Kawthar 108:2)

Qurbāni (Uḍḥiyyah) is the sacrifice of a specific animal on the days of Eid al-Aḍḥā (10th, 11th, 12th Dhul-Ḥijjah) in commemoration of the sacrifice of Ibrāhīm 'alayhis-salām.

The ruling: Qurbāni is Wājib upon every adult, sane Muslim who possesses the Niṣāb (the minimum threshold of wealth) on the days of Qurbāni, after deducting basic needs and debts. This is the position of the Ḥanafī school; the majority of scholars hold it to be a strongly emphasised Sunnah (Sunnah mu'akkadah).

Source: Sūrah al-Kawthar 108:2 · Al-Hidāyah



Eligible Animals

الحيوانات الجائزة

The following animals are eligible for Qurbāni:

1. Camel (jamal) — minimum age 5 years. Worth 7 shares.
2. Cow, ox, or buffalo (baqarah) — minimum age 2 years. Worth 7 shares.
3. Goat or sheep (ma'z/dājah) — minimum age 1 year. A sheep of 6 months is acceptable if it is so fat that it appears to be one year old. Worth 1 share (no sharing).

For a large animal (camel or cow), up to 7 people may share, provided each person's intention is Qurbāni (not mere meat-procurement). For a small animal (goat/sheep), only one person's Qurbāni may be made.

Source: Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 5547 · Sunan Abī Dāwūd 2810



Disqualifying Defects

العيوب المانعة

The following defects disqualify an animal from Qurbāni:

1. Blindness in one or both eyes (clearly visible).
2. Obvious lameness — the animal cannot walk to the place of slaughter.
3. Missing a third or more of an ear or the tail.
4. Missing a major limb.
5. Extreme emaciation — the animal has no marrow in its bones.
6. Missing more than one-third of the tongue.
7. Broken teeth — such that the animal cannot graze.

Minor defects (e.g. a small tear in the ear, a broken horn) do not disqualify but are disliked. The ideal Qurbāni animal is healthy, whole, and of good quality.

Source: Sunan Abī Dāwūd 2802 · Fatāwā Hindiyyah



The Method of Slaughter

طريقة الذبح

بسم الله، الله أكبر

The method of slaughter (dhabḥ):

1. Face the animal toward the qiblah.
2. Sharpen the blade well; spare the animal unnecessary pain.
3. Recite: "Bismillāhi Allāhu Akbar" ().
4. Recite the du'ā of Ibrāhīm 'alayhis-salām: "Innī wajjahtu wajhiya lilladhī faṭaras-samāwāti wal-arḍa ḥanīfan wa mā ana minal-mushrikīn. Inna ṣalātī wa nusukī wa maḥyāya wa mamātī lillāhi rabbil-'ālamīn, lā sharīka lah, wa bidhālīka umirtu wa ana minal-muslimīn."
5. For Qurbāni: add "Allāhumma taqabbal min [name]" (e.g. "Allāhumma taqabbal minnī" — O Allah, accept from me).
6. Cut the trachea (halq), oesophagus (marī'), and both jugular veins (wardān). Cutting all four is Sunnah; cutting at least three is necessary.

7. Do not skin or move the animal until it is fully cold (i.e. until all motion has ceased).

The knife should not be sharpened in front of the animal. The animal should not be dragged to the place of slaughter. One animal should not be slaughtered in front of another.

Source: Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 5565 · Sunan Abī Dāwūd 2815



Distribution of the Meat

توزيع اللحم

The Sunnah method of distribution is to divide the meat into three equal portions:

1. One-third for oneself and one's household.
2. One-third for friends and relatives (as a gift).
3. One-third for the poor and needy (as ṣadaqah).

This three-way division is Sunnah, not obligatory. It is permissible to give the entire animal away, or to keep it all for one's household.

It is not permissible to sell the meat of the Qurbāni animal, nor its skin. The skin may be used by the owner (e.g. as a prayer mat) or given away as ṣadaqah. If sold, the proceeds must be given as ṣadaqah.

The skin may also be given to a reliable Islamic organisation or madrasah as Lillah.

Source: Fatāwā Hindīyyah · Bahishti Zewar



Important Rulings

أحكام مهمة

1. The time of Qurbāni begins after the Eid Ṣalāh on the 10th of Dhul-Ḥijjah, and ends at sunset on the 12th. Qurbāni before the Eid Ṣalāh is not valid.

2. It is recommended (mustahabb) for the owner of the Qurbāni to slaughter it himself if he is able. If he is not, he should be present and witness it.
3. The one intending Qurbāni should not cut their hair or nails from the 1st of Dhul-Ḥijjah until after the Qurbāni is performed. (Sunan Abī Dāwūd 2791)
4. Qurbāni performed on behalf of a deceased person is valid, and its reward reaches the deceased.
5. A traveller (musāfir) is exempt from Qurbāni according to the Ḥanafī school.
6. Qurbāni is Wājib separately on each adult Muslim; the Qurbāni of the husband does not fulfil the wife's obligation (unless he makes intention on her behalf with her permission).

Source: Sunan Abī Dāwūd 2791 · Fatāwā Hindiyyah



جمعية العلماء جوهانسبرغ

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